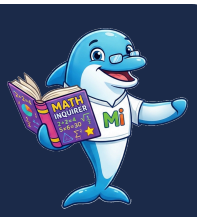
TUTOR NOTES • LEVEL 1 • TERM 2 • MI'S CHALLENGE QUEST

Mi's Challenge Quest



8 gates, one from each lesson of the term, all at Start here level, plus one optional secret cave item. 20 minutes after the break, played in pairs or as a group quest with Mi, working on private paper. It is a game: no score or mark is shown to the child, no ranking, no visible timer. You keep private notes only. For the tutor: do not hand these notes to families.

Where it sits. Lesson 20 (the last lesson of the term), minutes 35 to 55, the part Mi's Challenge Quest, straight after the brain break; or at the make-up slot. Owner decisions of 22 Oct 2026: the end-of-term slot is a game with Mi, not a test. The group plays it in pairs (a child and a quest partner) or as a group quest with Mi, on private paper. No score or mark is shown to the child, there is no ranking and no visible timer. The tutor keeps private notes only, for one line to each grown-up and for advice for next term's group. It keeps the 20-minute slot after the break and the question quality: 8 short gates and one optional secret cave item, all at Start here level. Lessons 13 and 14 share gate 3 and Lessons 15 and 16 share gate 4, so every lesson of the term is still visited. Gate 7 asks the child to try a friend's number by putting it back, which is the claim-trying the term line talks about. A middle child needs about 17 minutes of reading aloud and quiet work; a slower child may use a few minutes of the workbook time to finish. The quest sits straight after the brain break (not at the end of the lesson as in Term 1) so children are fresh. The Quest Log has no pictures except the ten-frames in gate 3, because the page generator draws only a few figure types.

1. The gates at a glance

Gate	From	Area (tutor label)	What it uses (Start here level)	Answer
1	L11	Whole Numbers; Addition and Subtraction	A place in a line (1st, 2nd, 3rd) and how many are in front	**5th; 3**
2	L12	Whole Numbers; Addition and Subtraction	A strip for more: the other person and the total	**35; 61**
3	L13	Whole Numbers; Addition and Subtraction	A double from ten-frames (Lesson 13) and odd or even (Lesson 14)	**18; odd**
4	L15	Multiplication and Division; Money	Groups of the same size and the times sign (Lesson 15), counting in 2s (Lesson 16)	**3 × 5 = 15; 8**
5	L17	Multiplication and Division; Money	Share equally and put into groups (Lesson 17)	**4; 5**
6	L18	Multiplication and Division; Money	A times story with a second step (Lesson 18)	**15; 11**
7	L19	Whole Numbers; Addition and Subtraction	A hidden number in a picture equation, and checking a friend's number (Lesson 19)	**No; 9**
8	L20	Multiplication and Division; Money	Find one first, then many (Lesson 20)	**$2; $10**
Secret cave	L11	Whole Numbers; Addition and Subtraction	Queue counting: 8th from the front and from the back, and checking a claim (optional)	**No; 15 children (7 in front of Ravi, Ravi, and 7 behind him)**

The area labels are for the tutor only and never appear on a child or parent page. Each gate is a fresh example of the Start here idea of its lesson (numbers chosen so that they do not repeat a lesson page), so a child who followed the lesson can open it. Before first use, read each gate against what the lesson actually taught.

2. Playing it: before and during

1. A week before: send the grown-up note (L20_Quest_Parent_Note.pdf) and the Quest Log (L20_Quest_Log.pdf, 3 pages) with the lesson materials. Families print the Quest Log at 100%, keep it closed in an envelope and find a quest partner (a grown-up or a brother or sister). A family with no printer tells you: arrange another way (for example the make-up slot).
2. Tell the group in the opening and at slide s-quest1: this is Mi's Challenge Quest, a game with Mi. Everyone works on their own paper with a quest partner beside them. It is not a race, a gate may be skipped, and nothing is shown to the group.
3. Start at minute 35 (straight after the brain break) and finish by minute 55. Children open the Quest Log only when you say. The paper lies flat on the table and is never held up. The quest partner may talk about how to start and ask 'how do you know?', but

does not give answers. Cameras may be on or off. Use your own watch out of sight of the camera: no clock, countdown or timer is ever shown to the children.

4. Read each page aloud, one gate at a time (the script has the words), then leave quiet working time: about 3 minutes for page 1, 3.5 for page 2 and 4 for page 3. After each page say that the gates are open and Mi swims on, whatever the answers. Say nothing about right or wrong, and read no answers. A middle child needs about 17 minutes in all; a slower child may finish in the first minutes of the workbook.
5. Allowed: fingers, counters and talk with the quest partner. Not allowed: a calculator, a grown-up giving answers, looking at the workbook. A child who finishes early turns the Quest Log over and draws quietly.
6. After page 2, take a one-minute stretch (stand, shake out, sip water). After page 3, show slide s-quest2. Do not collect or look at any Quest Log. While children work, notice (do not write on the shared screen) how they start: counters, drawing, strip, talking to the partner.

3. After the lesson: photos and your private notes

1. Same day: the grown-up takes ONE clear photo of each of the 3 pages (page flat, taken straight from above, the whole page in view, and the name on each page) and sends them to the program's business WhatsApp, +65 9880 5962, and to no other number. Never to a child, never to a personal phone, never into the class chat.
2. Within 3 days: open the photos only on the business WhatsApp (never on a personal phone) and write your private notes (section 5) for each child, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Section 4 shows what each answer tells you; accept 5 or 5th for gate 1 part a, and either order of 3 and 5 in gate 4. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is added up and no order of children is made. Nothing about the quest goes back to the child or the group except thanks.
3. Write ONE line for each grown-up from your notes (section 7): what we saw, in plain words, and one small next step if it helps. It is sent to the parent only. No marks, no x out of 8, no ranking, no comparison with other children, no prediction.
4. Fill in the group advice sheet (section 6): what several children were still working on, with no names, and what you will do in the first lessons of next term. It is kept for next term's tutor and is never shown to families.
5. Once the line is sent, save the photos to the program's private file store and delete them from the business WhatsApp chat. The program keeps the photos for 90 days after the program ends, then deletes them, as the privacy notice says. Delete each child's notes sheet when the line is sent (keep only the line in the family file, and the group advice sheet). Never forward the photos or save them to a personal phone or any other device.
6. At the start of next term say to the whole group: thank you for playing Mi's Challenge Quest; there is nothing to share and nothing to fear. Never name a child or an answer.

Privacy checklist

- Quest Logs are never held up to the camera and never read out.
- No answer is said aloud during or after the quest. Gates open for everyone, whatever the answers.
- No clock, countdown or timer is shown; nobody is told who finished first or last.
- Photos come to the program's business WhatsApp (+65 9880 5962) only; tutors never use a personal phone; photos are kept 90 days after the program ends, then deleted; the line goes to the parent only; no private message to any child.
- No score, no x out of 8, no ranking, no tally, no comparison between children, not even in your own notes.
- The recording captures the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted: the recording is paused for the whole quest (slides s-quest1 and s-quest2) and restarted for the workbook. The WhatsApp number is never on a slide.

Absent, late joiners, families who prefer not to, upset children

- A child who was away or whose family prefers another time: plays the quest at the make-up slot BEFORE watching the recording (the quest is not on the recording, so no gate is given away). It is a small group or a pair with Mi, with a parent beside the child on camera. The tutor never sits alone with one child on a private call.
- A child who joined late: the family may choose to leave out gates for lessons the child did not attend. Write nothing for those gates; if no gate of an area was taught, the line for the grown-up says nothing about that area.
- A family that does not want the quest: no problem. The child does the Lesson 20 work as usual and the line for the grown-up uses your own notes from the lessons only.
- A child who is upset or stuck: remind the group (open session) that every gate can be skipped and Mi swims round it. Do not single the child out. The grown-up may stop the quest at any time.
- A family with no printer: tell the family to say so a week before and arrange another way (for example the make-up slot, with the Quest Log sent to the family another way). Never ask a child about it in front of the group.

4. Answers and what to look for

Use these to understand what you see on camera and in the photos. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is totalled and no gate is marked right or wrong in front of anyone. A child may write steps in any clear layout. Spelling and neatness do not matter.

Gate 1 (L11) Siti is 4th in a line. Ben stands right behind Siti.
Answer: 5th; 3
(a) Ben is __ in the line. = 5th; (b) There are [ ] children in front of Siti. = 3
A secure answer looks like: Both correct (5th or 5 is right for part a). **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: Right behind the 4th child is the 5th. In front of Siti are the 1st, 2nd and 3rd children: 3 children.
Watch for: (a) 3rd or 4th.; (b) 4 (counting Siti herself).

Gate 2 (L12) Ravi has 26 marbles. Lily has 9 more marbles than Ravi.
Answer: 35; 61
(a) Lily has __ marbles. = 35; (b) They have __ marbles altogether. = 61
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** Part a right and part b wrong, or part b right from a wrong part a (counts as one).
Worked: Lily has 9 more than Ravi, so add: 26 + 9 = 35. Altogether: 26 + 35 = 61.
Watch for: (a) 17 (taking away).; (b) 35 (stopping after part a) or 35 + 9.

Gate 3 (L13) Look at the ten-frames.
Answer: 18; odd
(a) 9 + 9 = __ = 18; (b) Write odd or even. 15 is __. = odd
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 9 + 9 = 18 (one ten-frame is filled with 9, and so is the other: 10 + 8). 15 pairs up with 1 left over, so 15 is odd.
Watch for: (a) 17 or 19 (a counting slip).; (b) even (the last digit 5 is not read).

Gate 4 (L15) Jenny has 3 jars. Each jar has 5 sweets.
Answer: 3 × 5 = 15; 8
(a) Fill in the boxes. [ ] × [ ] = [ ][ ] = 3 × 5 = 15 (or 5 × 3); (b) Count in 2s: 2, 4, 6, __, 10 = 8
A secure answer looks like: Both correct (3 and 5 in either order, and 15). **Half way there:** One of the two correct, or the product right with the factors swapped or missing.
Worked: 3 groups of 5: 5 + 5 + 5 = 15, so 3 × 5 = 15 (5 × 3 = 15 is also right). Counting in 2s: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10.
Watch for: (a) 3 + 5 = 8.; (b) 7 (counting on by 1).

Gate 5 (L17) Siti shares 16 stickers equally among 4 friends. Kumar puts 10 pens into boxes, 2 pens in each box.
Answer: 4; 5
(a) Each of Siti's friends gets [ ] stickers. = 4; (b) Kumar needs [ ] boxes. = 5
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 16 shared equally among 4 friends is 4 each. 10 pens in groups of 2 make 5 boxes (2, 4, 6, 8, 10).
Watch for: (a) 12 (16 - 4) or 20.; (b) 8 (10 - 2) or 2 (the pens in each box).

Gate 6 (L18) Mei has 5 bags. Each bag has 3 sweets. She gives 4 sweets to Ben.
Answer: 15; 11
(a) The bags have __ sweets. = 20; (b) Mei has __ sweets left. = 17
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** Part a right and part b wrong (for example 19), or part b right from a wrong part a.
Worked: 5 groups of 3 is 15 sweets. She gives 4 away: 15 - 4 = 11.
Watch for: (a) 8 (adding 5 and 3).; (b) 19 (adding 4) or 4.

Gate 7 (L19) Each shape is a number. The heart + the heart = 18. Ben says the heart is 8.
Answer: No; 9
(a) Is Ben correct? Circle Yes or No. (Yes / No) = No; (b) The heart is __. = 9
A secure answer looks like: No and 9. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 8 + 8 = 16, not 18, so Ben is not correct. 9 + 9 = 18, so the heart is 9.
Watch for: (a) Yes (not checking by adding 8 + 8).; (b) 18 (the total).

Gate 8 (L20) 8 buns cost $16.

Answer: $2; $10

(a) 1 bun costs $__. = 2; (b) 5 buns cost $__. = 10

A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** Part a right and part b wrong, or part b right from a wrong part a.

Worked: $16 shared equally among 8 buns is $2 each. 5 buns cost 5 groups of $2, which is $10.

Watch for: (a) 24 (adding) or 128.; (b) 16 (the total) or 7 (2 + 5).

Secret cave (optional) (L11) Ravi is 8th from the front and 8th from the back of a line. Mei says there are 16 children in the line.

Answer: No; 15 children (7 in front of Ravi, Ravi, and 7 behind him)

(a) Is Mei correct? Circle Yes or No. (Yes / No) = No; (b) There are __ children in the line. = 15

A secure answer looks like: The answer is as above. **Half way there:** -

Worked: There are 7 children in front of Ravi and 7 behind him, and Ravi himself: 7 + 7 + 1 = 15. 8 + 8 = 16 counts Ravi twice.

Watch for: 16 (counting Ravi twice).; 14 (leaving Ravi out).

5. Tutor private notes (tutor only; one sheet per child; delete when the line is sent)

Child (first name only): ..... Date: ..... Quest partner: .....

Fill this in after the lesson, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Write what the child did and said in your own words. No ticks for right or wrong, no points, nothing added up. The gate numbers are only reminders of where to look.

Gate	From	What I saw (words used, counters or drawing, how the partner helped, anything the child said)
1	L11	
2	L12	
3	L13	
4	L15	
5	L17	
6	L18	
7	L19	
8	L20	
Cave	L11	

Prompt	My notes
Something the child did well (a named strength, for example: drew a strip to find how many more marbles one child had)	
How they started: counters, drawing a strip, ten-frames, or in their head	
Where they paused or turned to their partner, and what helped	
One next step for home (small and concrete)	
Did they try the secret cave? (a neutral note only)	

The one line for the grown-up (section 7), written from these notes:

.....

.....

6. Group advice for next term (tutor only; one sheet per class; no names)

When all the notes are written, look across them without names. Write what several children were still working on and how you will use the first two lessons of next term (a warm-up, a picture, a game). This page never goes to families.

Area	What several children were still working on (no names)	What I will do in the first two lessons of next term
Numbers, adding and taking away Lessons 11 to 19: places in a line (1st, 2nd, 3rd), strips for more and fewer, doubles, odd and even numbers, and finding a hidden number in a picture equation		
Groups, sharing and stories about groups Lessons 15 to 20: groups of the same size and the times sign, counting in 2s and 5s, sharing equally and putting into groups, stories about groups with a second step, and finding the cost of one first		

Prompt	My notes
Gates or ideas where several children paused (no names)	
A warm-up or game to bring back in the first lesson of next term	
What worked well about the quest as a game, to keep next time	

7. The one line for the grown-up: what we saw

Mi's Challenge Quest: [Name]
In Mi's Challenge Quest, [Name] [one specific thing you saw, in plain words]. [Optional: one small next step at home.]

One or two sentences at most. Say what the child did (drew a strip, shared equally, explained a step), not how many answers were right. Use the lines below as patterns and always add your own detail from your notes.

Area (parent wording)	Things you might have seen (pick the one your notes show; add the detail)	A next step that helps at home
Numbers, adding and taking away Lessons 11 to 19. We looked at places in a line (1st, 2nd, 3rd), strips for more and fewer, doubles, odd and even numbers, and finding a hidden number in a picture equation.	• [Name] found a place in a line (1st, 2nd, 3rd) and used a strip to find the other number and the total. • [Name] doubled numbers and told odd from even using the ten-frames. • [Name] tried a friend's number in a picture equation by putting it back, and explained what happened.	• Line up toys at home and say 1st, 2nd, 3rd; draw two strips for more and fewer stories. • Put a number back into a sum to try it, with counters.
Groups, sharing and stories about groups Lessons 15 to 20. We looked at groups of the same size and the times sign, counting in 2s and 5s, sharing equally and putting into groups, stories about groups with a second step, and finding the cost of one first.	• [Name] wrote groups of the same size with the times sign and counted in 2s. • [Name] shared equally and put things into groups, using counters or a drawing. • [Name] solved a story about groups with a second step, and found the cost of one first.	• Share real counters onto plates to find how many on each. • Count groups of the same size with cups and counters, then say the times sentence.

A filled example (fictional child, Mei)

Mi's Challenge Quest: Mei
In Mi's Challenge Quest, Mei drew a strip to find how many more marbles one child had, and shared 16 stickers equally among 4 friends. A good next step: share real counters onto plates at home to find how many in each.

This line describes Mei's own thinking in the game. It does not compare children.

Words to avoid in the line: score, mark, out of, rank, top, below average, behind, ahead of, pass, fail, predicted, ready for. No claim about school exams, GEP or any contest, and no mention of other children. The line goes to the parent only. If the child skipped the secret cave or a gate, say nothing about it. If the child tried the secret cave, you may add: "[Name] also had a go at the secret cave."